

Nathan Walters, M.S.

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UX Researcher | United States Veteran

End-to-end user-centered designer with 13 years of experience in IT. I'm passionate about UX and learning new skills in research, data analysis, and emerging technology. I'm self-taught in Medallia, DB2, Tableau, and AI prompt engineering to vibe code.

Education

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University

- Master of Science in Human Factors (concentration in Systems Engineering)
- Bachelor of Science in Human Factors Psychology (concentration in Human-Computer Interaction)

Professional Experience

Senior User Experience Specialist Lead

CGI Federal- Woodlawn, MD

Jan 2026 – Present

- Leading nine UX experts to modernize legacy systems and exceed client expectations in the public sector.
- Design research studies to collect user feedback through interviews, surveys, card sorts, or usability testing.
- Leading a UX team to enhance digital products through AI, end-to-end user research, and UI design.
- Create and maintain a UX backlog to deliver UX solutions through continuous improvement.

Senior Customer Experience Data Analyst

Social Security Administration - Woodlawn, MD

Jan 2022 – Sept 2025

- Received Commissioner award for driving the strategic transition of an enterprise Voice of Customer (VoC) program to ensure 99% feedback collection uptime.
- Planned and coordinated continuous improvement in feedback collection, data quality, and data reporting.
- Led customer feedback data governance to ensure accurate mapping to journey touchpoint and thematic analysis by AI.
- Diagrammed process flows using FigJam to show intersections of people, processes, and technology.
- Used Excel, Tableau, GA, and Medallia to deliver insights from interaction, outcome, and customer data to inform decision making through data visualizations.
- Increased digital user engagement by 15% and boosted customer satisfaction by 2–3% on a platform serving 30M monthly users. Established and met 2-3% annual KPI for CSAT.
- Received Commissioner Team Award for building feedback access to the SSI 'Basic Needs' campaign.
- Reduced analysis time and scaled insights by applying rule-based NLP AI to categorize 1M+ open-ended responses annually for thematic analysis.
- Upskilled 300+ employees—including executives—on VoC tools and led continuous improvement training.
- Received 2025 Service to the Citizen Team Award for designing the Social Security Service Index.

User Experience Design Lead

Social Security Administration - Woodlawn, MD

Apr 2021 – Jan 2022

- Facilitated 100+ interviews and usability tests to uncover insights that improved product performance.
- Designed solutions aligning with NIST policy guidelines for Digital Identity.
- Led a four-person team in redesigning mobile-first digital identity products, increasing user success rates from ~40% to ~80% through multi-year iterative, user-centered research and design.
- Created longitudinal research studies examining staff behaviors and technology usage during customer interactions remotely and in-person.
- Earned Commissioner Team Award for delivering critical enhancements to Digital Identity Product.
- Built personas and facilitated usability tests across product iterations to guide strategic decisions.

UX Design Specialist

Northrop Grumman - Woodlawn, MD

Jan 2019 – Apr 2021

- Developed user flows based on ethnographic research and primary data collection.
- Built surveys in Qualtrics, conducted user interviews, usability testing, and prototype product designs.
- Created storyboards and performed heuristic evaluations to improve digital products.
- Designed a chatbot interface for the Centers of Medicare and Medicaid Services in HTML and CSS.

Research Assistant

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University - Daytona Beach, FL

May 2017 - Apr 2018

- Led market research studies to understand user perceptions of automation products.
- Collected and analyzed qualitative and quantitative data using NVIVO and SPSS software programs.
- Facilitated flight simulation studies to gather behavioral data for flight safety.

Digital Product Sales

Digital Factory Network – Trenton, TN

Jan 2012 - Jan 2015

- Developed client relationships to enhance brand awareness and ensure customer value delivery.
- Mitigated client experiences by designing proactive ways to prevent barriers disrupting path to purchase.

United States Army

Human Resources Information Systems Management - Honorable Discharge

June 2004 –May 2010

- Prepared, reviewed, analyzed, and processed data across regions to present trends to leadership.
- Monitors the status of unresolved errors and initiates required corrective action.

Certifications

- Certified Usability Architect | Human Factors International | June 2026
- Certified Scrum Product Owner | Scrum Alliance | August 2025
- AI and Career Empowerment | University of Maryland | July 2025
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt | Project Management Institute | March 2025